

Transparency: An Introduction

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What do we mean by “transparency” in research?

Part of the research process includes: sharing data, sharing designs, sharing pre-analysis plans (PAPs), sharing deviations from plans.

Share with whom?

- The public
- Other researchers
- Policy makers and other decision makers (in government, in organizations, in society)
- Political actors
- **Your future self** (Bowers and Voors 2016).

Why transparency?

- Makes it easier for people to interpret your results.
 - Makes it easier for you to justify your choices about: design, analysis, interpretation.
 - Helps center the debate on substance rather than methods.
- Makes the investigator accountable to a community (or communities).
- Makes **future you** happier with **present you** (Bowers and Voors 2016).

How transparency?

- Share designs and pre-analysis plans on the [EGAP Registry](#) or [OSF](#) or [AEA](#) or an easy form at [AsPredicted](#).
- Gather the priors and hopes of a community of researchers at the [Social Science Prediction Platform](#).
- Follow best practices for using code to change the world:
 - Bowers and Voors (2016) and [10 Things To Know about Project Workflow](#)¹.
 - for example, share your code on GitHub (see [the repository for Rabb, Bowers, et al. \(2022\)](#) or the [repository for Rabb, Swindal, et al. \(2022\)](#)).
 - See the [OES Project Process](#) for how a **team** does transparency.
 - See the [Lab@DC OSF page](#) for examples of registrations.

¹see also [some of the opinionated guides about using LaTeX](#)

References

- Bowers, Jake, and Maarten Voors. 2016. "Six Steps to a Better Relationship with Your Future Self, v 2.0." *Revista de Ciencia Política* 36 (3): 829–48.
- Rabb, Nathaniel, Jake Bowers, David Glick, Kevin H. Wilson, and David Yokum. 2022. "The Influence of Social Norms Varies with 'Others' Groups: Evidence from COVID-19 Vaccination Intentions." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 119 (29).
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- Rabb, Nathaniel, Megan Swindal, David Glick, et al. 2022. "The Limits of Nudges: Results of a Statewide Vaccination RCT." *Nature*, April. <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41586-022-04526-2>.